

Comprehensive English notes from the morning current affairs class (Session date: August 6, 2026), covering the latest news updates and the concluding section of the Karnataka exam paper. All facts, figures, names and geography points from the session are included below for revision.

## 1. Indian-Flagged Cargo Ship Crisis in the Red Sea

An Indian-flagged cargo vessel got stranded and eventually crashed/sank in the Red Sea. A total of 14 sailors were rescued, of whom 13 were Indian nationals.

### Key facts:

- Name of the vessel: **Faiz Noor Aulia**.
- Location of the incident: **Red Sea** (between Africa and Asia).
- Attack is attributed to the **Houthi** rebel group, based in **Yemen** (capital: Sana'a; key port city: Aden).
- Houthis are supported by **Iran**; their conflict is mainly with **Saudi Arabia**.
- Exact reason for the attack on an Indian vessel is still unknown/unconfirmed (Iran is considered friendly with India, making the motive unclear).
- About 12–15% of global trade passes through this Red Sea shipping route.
- Saudi Arabia had earlier formed a 13-nation coalition (including Pakistan) against the Houthis.

### Regional seas and geography (continent boundaries):

- **Arabian Sea** – located near India.
- **Mediterranean Sea** – lies between Africa and Europe.
- **Red Sea** – lies between Africa and Asia.
- **Black Sea** – lies between Europe and Asia.
- Key waterways near Yemen: Sinai Peninsula, Suez Canal, the **Bab-el-Mandeb Strait**, and the **Gulf of Aden**, leading into the Arabian Sea.
- Another key strait on the alternate (Persian Gulf) route is the **Strait of Hormuz**.

### Other regional rebel/militant groups to remember:

- **Houthis** – Yemen.
- **Hamas** – Gaza.
- **Hezbollah** – Lebanon.
- **Boko Haram** – North Africa (around the Mali region).

## 2. Karnataka Paper – Polity Section (Concluding Part)

### Q1. Who participates in the election of the President of India?

Elected members of the Lok Sabha, elected members of the Rajya Sabha, and elected members of the State Legislative Assemblies take part. **Nominated members do NOT participate**. Correct answer: Option 4.

### Q2. Which Union Territories do not have representation "in the State" (i.e., no Legislative Assembly / relevant to Rajya Sabha representation)?

Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu have no Legislative Assembly, while Delhi does have an Assembly and representatives. The question specifically asks about "in the State" (referring to the Council of States / Rajya Sabha context) — the discussion pointed to Chandigarh, Lakshadweep and Ladakh as UTs without such representation.

### Q3. Under Article 163, the Council of Ministers advises whom?

The Council of Ministers headed by the Chief Minister advises the **Governor of the State** (not the Legislative Assembly).

### Q4. If a Governor resigns, to whom does he/she submit the resignation?

To the **President of India** — because the Governor is appointed by the President, and can be removed by the President as well.

### Q5. Highest legal advisor to the Government of India?

The **Attorney General of India**, provided for under **Article 76** of the Constitution.

### Finance Commission Chairpersons – Match the Following

A matching-type question listing Finance Commissions (1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th, 5th) with their chairpersons was solved in class. Correct match sequence worked out as: **3, 1, 4, 2** (1st Commission matched with option 3; final answer selected was Option B).

## 3. "India Day" Declared by US Cities on 15th August

Two places in the USA have declared that 15th August will be celebrated as "India Day" so that the Indian community/diaspora living there can also celebrate India's Independence Day.

- **State: Massachusetts** — Governor **Maura Healey** made the announcement.
- **City: Boston** — Mayor **Michelle Wu** made the announcement.
- Context: During USA's 4th of July celebrations ("Sail 250" event), IAS officer **Sudarshini** represented India and travelled to Boston, then onward to Portugal.

- Reason: A large Indian diaspora (Indians settled abroad for jobs/education/family) resides in these areas, hence the dedication of 15th August as India Day.
- India will celebrate its **79th Independence Day** on 15 August 2026.

#### Independence Days to remember:

- **India** – 15 August (1947).
- **Pakistan** – 14 August.
- **Balochistan** – 11 August (self-declared, celebrated a few days before Pakistan).

## 4. India–US Defence Exercises and US Geography

#### Major India–US joint military exercises:

- **Yudh Abhyas** (Army exercise).
- **Tiger Triumph** (tri-services exercise).
- **Vajra Prahar** (special forces exercise).

#### US Geography pointers:

- USA borders Canada to the north and Mexico to the south.
- **Rio Grande River** lies between the USA and Mexico.
- The **49th Parallel** is the line marking the US–Canada border.
- The **Great Lakes** region has five lakes — remembered by the acronym **HOMES**: **H**uron, **O**ntario, **M**ichigan, **E**rie, **S**uperior.
- **Lake Superior** is the largest of the Great Lakes.

## 5. India's First African Swine Fever (ASF) Vaccine

- India has developed its **first vaccine for African Swine Fever**, a disease affecting domestic and wild pigs.
- ASF is common in sub-Saharan African regions and is caused by a **DNA-based virus** (spread via a **tick** vector).
- Cases in India were reported in North-East India and North India.
- Vaccine developed by **ICAR** (Indian Council of Agricultural Research), founded on **16 July**.
- Director: **Mangi Lal Ji**.
- Vaccine name: **MA-104**.
- Storage temperature: **4°C to 8°C**.
- Vaccine launched from **Bhopal**.

#### Related viral diseases (region-wise):

- **Nipah virus** – found in **Kerala**.
- **Ebola virus** – found in the **Congo** region.
- **Zika virus** – found in **South America** (e.g., Brazil).

## 6. Sports & Development Indices

**First Summer Paralympic Games:** Held in **Rome, 1960**.

**Human Development Index (HDI):** Released by **UNDP**; based on Health, Education (reading & writing/education standard), and Standard of Living. India's recent HDI ranking discussed was around **130**.

## 7. Operation Trishul – Bringing Back Fugitives

Meaning of "fugitive": A person who has committed a crime against the nation (financial crime/black money, terrorism, sexual offences, narcotics, etc.) and has fled the country, often acquiring foreign citizenship — making extradition dependent on the host country's permission (e.g., Vijay Mallya remains in the UK for this reason).

- **Interpol** (International Police) — headquartered in **Lyon, France**; formed in **1923**. India's **CBI** participates in Interpol proceedings.
- Under **Operation Trishul**, India brought back around **274 fugitives**.
- Law used: **Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), 2002**.
- Fugitives were brought back from around **140 countries** (over the last several years).

## 8. Supreme Court Ruling – Buffer Zones Around Wetlands

- Supreme Court has ruled that a **10 km buffer zone** will be created around wetlands (not national parks) where no human activity will be allowed, to protect the ecosystem.
- First site to implement this: **Asan Conservation Reserve, Uttarakhand**.
- Governing law: **Wetland (Conservation and Management) Rules, 2017**.
- Wetlands include rivers, lakes and marsh areas.
- **World Wetlands Day:** 2 February.
- **Ramsar Convention:** Held in 1971 in **Ramsar, Iran**.

- States with the most Ramsar sites in India: **Uttar Pradesh** and **Tamil Nadu**.
- India currently has **101 Ramsar sites** in total.
- Latest Ramsar site: **Arunachal Pradesh's first Ramsar site** — a lake also referenced as "Glol Lake" (Gyolinguek/Glol Ering).

## 9. Quick Science Facts

- **Fish oil** is a rich source of **Omega-3 fatty acids**.
- Plant group examples with **modified leaves**: **Garlic** and **Cactus**.

## 10. RBI Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) Meeting

- Current RBI Governor: **Sanjay Malhotra** — **26th Governor of RBI**.
- Recently appointed Executive Director (ED) of RBI: **Monisha**.
- MPC meets every **2 months**; its role is to regulate the **Repo Rate**, **CRR**, **SLR** and control **inflation**.
- MPC has been meeting regularly since **2016**; headed by the **RBI Governor**; comprises 3 RBI members and 3 Government of India members.
- RBI-side members discussed: **Sanjay Malhotra** (Governor), **Poonam Gupta** (Deputy Governor), and nominee **Indraneel** (external member).
- **Repo Rate** kept unchanged at **5.25%**; **Bank Rate** at **5.50%**.
- GDP growth projections: current **~6.6%**, expected to reach **6.7%** going forward, and **7.3% by 2028**.
- Inflation trending upward — currently around **4.4%**, expected to rise further.

## 11. Astronomy – Match the Planet with Period of Revolution

A match-the-following question on planets and their period of revolution around the Sun was solved; correct match for Option A was with Option 2 (A→2).

## 12. India's First Indigenous Satellite Battery – "Power Bank 50"

- Developed by Indian startup **Tech Me To Space**.
- Flown aboard **Skyroot Aerospace's** (Hyderabad-based startup) **Vikram-1** rocket, launched under the **Agnibaan** programme.
- Deployed into **Low Earth Orbit (LEO)**, roughly 400–500 km altitude.
- Awarded the status of India's first **"Flight Heritage"** indigenous satellite battery — recognition given because it was the first time India built and flew its own satellite battery of this kind.

## 13. Key Appointments

- **Deputy Chief of Naval Staff**: Vice Admiral **A. N. Pramod** — served in **Operation Sindoor** and **Operation Vijay** (Kargil); took charge from **1 August**, after 36 years of service in the Indian Navy.
- **Chief of the Naval Staff**: **Krishna Swaminathan**.
- **Chief of the Army Staff**: **Dheeraj Seth**.

## 14. World Records & Sports Achievements

### Youngest Professor – Guinness World Record

- **Nathan Thomas** (age 18 years 346 days), from **Florida, USA**, has become the world's youngest professor, teaching engineering students at a university.
- He broke a **306-year-old record** held by **Colin Maclaurin** (who became a professor at age 19, in **1717**).

### Anahat Singh – World Junior Squash Champion

- India's **Anahat Singh** won the **World Junior Squash Championship**, defeating **Rukaiya** of **Egypt** in the final (score 3–0).
- Event held every **2 years**, for players under **19 years** of age; started in **2009**.
- This edition was hosted at **Niagara-on-the-Lake, Canada**, concluding on **31 July**.
- Anahat Singh is the **first Indian** to win this title (India's earlier best was a runner-up finish by **Joshna** in 2005).
- Men's title winner: **Mohamed Zakaria** of **Egypt** — Egypt has won the women's title for **11 consecutive years**.
- Medal ceremony held in **Delhi** by the **Ministry of Sports**, headed by **Mansukh Mandaviya**.

## 15. Meghalaya's "Mission Clouded Leopard"

Meghalaya has launched its own "Mission Clouded Leopard" since the Clouded Leopard is the **state animal** of Meghalaya. **Clouded Leopard Day** was observed on **4 August**.

## 16. Quick Revision – One-Line Facts

| Topic | Key Fact |
|-------|----------|
|       |          |

|                                               |                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Balochistan Independence Day                  | 11 August                                                      |
| Executive Director, RBI                       | Monisha                                                        |
| Kalpana Chawla / Vikram Sarabhai Medal        | Awarded to Annapurna Ji                                        |
| Burevestnik-type / Bandmaster missile display | Displayed/showcased by Russia (not yet launched operationally) |
| Arunachal Pradesh's first Ramsar site         | Glol Lake                                                      |
| New PAI insurance product (DFS)               | Launched under Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool                  |
| South India's first semiconductor unit        | To be set up in Andhra Pradesh                                 |
| Organ Donation Day (India)                    | 3 August; Tamil Nadu leads in organ donations                  |
| New catfish species discovered (Odisha)       | Named after 'Khairi'                                           |
| Clouded Leopard Day                           | 4 August                                                       |

*Note: This is homework for self-revision (to be answered/discussed in the comment section as per the instructor). Additional current affairs magazine ("Pragyan", available in Hindi and English) and the SSC CGL crash course were also announced in the session.*